

Product Requirements Document

Campus Errand Marketplace — OAU Student Task Platform

1. Overview

A peer-to-peer web platform that lets Obafemi Awolowo University (OAU) students post small paid tasks (errands) and have other verified students claim and complete them. Version 1 is scoped to OAU only, as a validation phase before any wider rollout.

2. Problem Statement

Students regularly need small tasks done — picking up a package, printing and submitting a document, queueing at the bursary, running a quick errand — but have no structured, trustworthy way to find someone to do it, or to be paid to do it for others. Informal arrangements over WhatsApp or word of mouth are unreliable and carry no protection for either side.

3. Goals

- Give students a fast, trustworthy way to get small tasks done by other students.
- Give students a flexible way to earn money on campus by completing tasks.
- Validate real demand on OAU's campus before considering wider rollout.
- Protect both sides of a transaction so payment and task completion are both guaranteed.

4. Target Users & Scope

Users: OAU students only, verified at registration via matric number and/or school email domain. Every user can act as both a task poster and a task doer (dual role) — there is no separate account type.

Scope for v1: OAU campus only. This is a deliberate constraint to validate the product before any multi-campus expansion is considered.

5. Core Features

5.1 Task Posting

- A poster can create a task with a description, price, and location.
- Task categories are open-ended (any legal task), rather than a fixed list.

- The poster sets the task price directly. The system separately estimates a transport cost based on distance between campus zones, shown as a distinct line item alongside the task price.
- A poster may optionally set a hard deadline (e.g. “must be completed by 2pm”) for time-sensitive tasks.
- A poster specifies what counts as valid proof of completion for the task (e.g. a photo of the delivered item, a receipt, a screenshot of a submission confirmation), so the doer knows exactly what to capture rather than guessing.

5.2 Task Discovery & Claiming

- Available tasks are shown to nearby students, sorted by proximity to the task location.
- Claiming is first-come-first-claimed in v1. A bidding/offer system is explicitly out of scope for v1 (see Section 7).

5.3 Task Lifecycle & States

Each task moves through a defined state machine:

- **Open** — visible and unclaimed. If unclaimed past a time window (poster-set or default), the task automatically moves to **Expired** and the poster is notified to repost or adjust the price.
- **Claimed** — a doer has accepted the task. If no progress is shown within a grace period, the task automatically releases back to Open, and repeated no-shows affect the doer's rating.
- **In Progress** — the doer is actively completing the task.
- **Completed** — the doer marks the task done. A photo (matching what the poster specified as valid proof at posting) is required before the status can change to Completed — this is not optional, since it is the primary evidence used if a dispute is raised.
- **Confirmed / Released** — the poster confirms completion and payment is released to the doer. If the poster does not respond within a set window (e.g. 24 hours), the task auto-confirms and payment is released, so a doer is not left waiting indefinitely on an unresponsive poster.
- **Missed Deadline** — applies only to tasks with a hard deadline. If the deadline passes before completion, the task is marked Missed Deadline, the poster is automatically refunded, and it counts against the doer's reliability rating.
- **Disputed** — either party can flag an issue via a “Report an issue” action. This freezes the payout until manually reviewed and resolved (see Section 5.5).

5.4 Payments

Payment is collected upfront from the poster through Paystack (Starter Business tier, which does not require CAC business registration). Funds settle to the platform's own account rather than being released automatically, because Starter Business accounts do not have access to

Paystack's Transfers API. Release to the doer is therefore a manual step performed once a task reaches Confirmed / Released status — functioning as a manual escrow layer in v1.

This directly protects both sides: a doer cannot be paid without completing the task, since funds are held until confirmation; and a poster cannot avoid paying after a task is completed, since funds are already collected before work begins.

Planned for v2: registering the platform as a formal business to unlock the Transfers API and automate payout, removing the manual release bottleneck.

5.5 Disputes

Disputes are handled manually in v1, not automated. Reporting an issue freezes the associated payout and flags it for manual review. Photo proof of completion (submitted at the Completed stage) is the primary evidence used to resolve disputes.

5.6 Trust, Verification & Ratings

- Accounts are verified at signup via matric number and/or school email domain, so users are not anonymous.
- After every completed task, both parties rate each other (poster rates the doer's work; doer rates the poster's clarity/promptness). Average ratings are shown on each user's profile.
- Rating history feeds a trust tier system: new users are capped at lower-value tasks; a track record of completed tasks and good ratings unlocks access to higher-value tasks. This limits worst-case exposure from unproven users while the platform is still small.

5.7 Notifications

In-app notifications only for v1 (task claimed, status changes, payout released, disputes).

WhatsApp notification integration is planned for a later version, once core functionality is validated.

6. Out of Scope for v1

- Bidding / price negotiation on tasks (deferred to v2 — v1 is first-come-first-claimed only).
- Automated escrow via Paystack Transfers API (requires business registration; v1 uses manual release).
- Native mobile app (v1 is a web app, built as a PWA where practical).
- Multi-campus support.
- Automated dispute resolution.
- WhatsApp / SMS notifications.

7. Success Metrics

- Number of verified active users.

- Number of tasks posted and completed weekly.
- Task completion rate (tasks completed vs. tasks posted).
- Repeat usage rate (users who post or complete more than one task).

8. Assumptions & Constraints

- Platform is built and maintained by a single founder, handling both frontend and backend.
- Paystack Starter Business tier is used to avoid CAC registration costs at this stage; this caps collections and withholds access to the Transfers API until the business is formally registered.
- Manual processes (payout release, dispute resolution) are acceptable at current expected scale and are treated as a deliberate v1 simplification, not an oversight.
- OAU-only scope in v1 is intentional, to validate demand before considering expansion.

9. Future Considerations (v2+)

- Bidding system for task pricing, once user behavior data shows demand for it.
- Formal business registration to unlock automated Paystack Transfers and remove the manual payout step.
- WhatsApp notification integration.
- Expansion beyond OAU to additional campuses.
- Automated or semi-automated dispute handling as volume grows.